

2026-08-16 — Toledo's שמחתי, Adam HaRishon's Sunrise, and the מחזור ויטרי Rebuttal

Content-based review · reviewer read the transcript, summary, and finished write-up · 16 August 2026

1. The Shiur in One Paragraph

This is week two of the Shabbos Shacharis arc, and Rabbi Ephrati is working systematically through the added kapitlach of פסוקי דזמרה — asking, for each, why it is there and where it came from. The frame is the ברוך of ברכה מסגרת, with the Nusach Sfar/Nusach Ashkenaz split explained as an accommodation for latecomers who need to be יוצא ברוך שאמר / ישתבח. From there he moves through three "reasons for the additions" (Tosfos's angelic-shira model, the Tur's תרחא דצבורא, and Rabbeinu Shlomo miGermaiza's striking claim that the expanded Shabbos set was originally the daily norm), then anchors three narratives to specific kapitlach: Ibn Shushan's 1180 Toledo synagogue as the sole Rishonic source for שמחתי (per the ספר (המנהיג), Adam HaRishon's first sunrise for שבת ליום שיר, and the מחזור ויטרי's furious rebuttal of the Shimon Kefa legend on נשמת. The through-line is history-of-siddur — how did specific texts land in our davening, and what is the human story behind them.

2. What Was Strongest

- **The latecomer explanation for Nusach Sfar's inversion** is genuinely illuminating and consistent with the Rav's recurring theme in this series. It reframes what looks like a structural anomaly (kapitlach placed *before* the opening bracha) as a halachic accommodation via שומע

כעונה. This is the kind of "why does it look this way" answer that pays real dividends for the mispallel.

- **The Ibn Shushan / Toledo story tied to שמחתי** is the highlight of the shiur — a specific, dated, geographically located human moment (1180, one shul's inauguration) that seeded a universal minhag. The Rav's own puzzlement ("this kapittel doesn't appear in any Rishonim... only one") is the right framing, and pushing the oilam to fact-check him is a healthy move. The pairing with Gemara Makkos 10 (Dovid hearing מתי ימות זקן זה and choosing joy over insult) gives the pasuk real emotional weight.
- **אנו מרמיזא's chiddush** that the expanded Shabbos set was originally daily — with the wistful "והאומרם כל יום תבא עליו ברכה" — is the kind of hidden Rishonic gem that reframes what we're actually saying every Shabbos. It elevates the added kapitlach from "extras" to "the original template preserved."
- **The Adam HaRishon / first sunrise piece for מזמור שיר ליום השבת** landed emotionally, especially with the Ritva's החטא מבלבלו — a fine chiddush that sin doesn't destroy intellect but disorients emunah. Good pshat, well-integrated.

3.What Was Weaker or Worth Pushing Back On

The Nishmas piece was thin and left dangling. The Rav ran out of time and truncated exactly the most important part — the **זמור ויטרי** **לפני** **הפסוק** **הגדולה** authorship. He gave us the legend in full detail but only gestured at the rebuttal. For a "painful sugya" that he chose to open, this deserved either its own shiur or a tighter time-budget earlier. As it stands, some listeners walked out with the Shimon Kefa story more vivid than the refutation — the opposite of the pedagogical goal.

Attribution question on the Nishmas rebuttal. The Rav names "מחזור
ישיב" but the classical rebuttal on Nishmas authorship is more commonly cited
in the name of Rabbeinu Tam / Sefer HaYashar and echoed by later Rishonim; the

does discuss Nishmas but the "formulation is generally traced to a different source. Worth asking the Rav to nail down the exact citation.

The מהרי"ל / קצרת והאמונה piece felt underdeveloped. The Rav noted the מהרי"ל restricts it to Yom Kippur, admitted the Shabbos-vs-Yom-Kippur kedusha question ("הא ינאמי", אפ"ש and moved on. The real lomdish question — is Shabbos's madrega-of-malach status halachically the same category the מהרי"ל was gating on? — went unanswered. He could have brought the Rama or later poskim who defend the Chassidishe minhag.

Sourcing for מצנו שלמה מגרמייזא was loose. The Rav volunteered he was "in middle of researching it, I stayed here last night... I don't have my books." That's fine as candor, but for a claim as big as "the Rishonim originally required this daily," the specific siman in the siddur would help the talmid go home and check.

The Adam HaRishon קולבנות pose end. Naftali's sharp question on שביתת פלים and the Rav's own extension about Adam bringing מקבנות Shabbos — was flagged as a real difficulty and then dismissed with "maybe the קבנות were only Sunday." That's a real מלוקק ראשונים worth naming rather than waving at.

4. Halachic / Lomdish Observations

On the latecomer sevara for Nusach Sfar: the Rav didn't mention that this is exactly parallel to the sevara often given for why מקבלת שבת was added — creating "runway" before Maariv for the tzibbur to gather. Would have been a nice cross-reference tying the Shabbos evening and Shabbos morning structures together under one design principle.

On מקבנות being unattested outside ספר המנהיג the Avudraham *does* discuss the מקבנות group in ספר דומרה contexts, and there's a case to check whether the Ibn Shushan innovation was picked up because it was aligned with pre-existing Sephardic tefillah-tastes for the ספר המעלות Did Toledo

| start a minhag from scratch, or ratify one already brewing? The Rav treated it as
| pure Toledo-invention; the reality may be a synthesis.

| **On | שיר ליום השבת** **being said twice** (once end of | מסוקי דזמרה
| as | שיר של יום Bernie's question was excellent and the Rav answered off the
| cuff. The Levush and Mishnah Berurah both address this directly. The pat answer
| was correct but the standard sources deserved a name-drop.

| **On | האדרת והאמונה** the Arizal's chiddush that it belongs specifically to
| Shabbos because of the seventh-wing/malach status is exactly the counter to the
| מהרי"ל the Rav needed. He mentioned "mekubalim say Kabbalah stuff" but
| didn't articulate that the Arizal is the halachic ground for the Chassidishe minhag
| against the | מהרי"ל

| **The Ritva on Adam HaRishon and | הפוסטא מבלבלו** beautiful — worth
| noting it parallels the Ramchal in Mesillas Yesharim on how aveiros " | מטמטמים
| אאל the same psychological/spiritual mechanism. Would enrich the pshat.

5. Follow-up Questions Worth Asking the Rav

| Q1. Can you nail down the exact citation for the Nishmas rebuttal — | מחזור ויטרי
| siman? Rabbeinu Tam's Sefer HaYashar? Both? — and next week walk us through
| the | אציות | authorship you didn't get to?

| Q2. | רבנו שלמה מגרמיזא claim that the expanded | מסוקי דזמרה was originally
| daily — is that widely accepted among Rishonim, or is he a | עת יחיד Any other
| Rishon who echoes it?

| Q3. If Ibn Shushan is the true origin of | שמחתי why did *only* Nusach Sfarad adopt
| it and not Nusach Ashkenaz? What's the transmission path from Toledo to the
| Chassidishe siddurim?

| Q4. On | האדרת והאמונה practically, what should a Litvishe yid who davens
| Nusach Sfarad do? Skip it? Say it silently? Is there a Chazon Ish or Rav Moshe on
| this?

| Q5. On Adam HaRishon's malachim playing | שבתת Shabbos — Naftali's | שבתת

question. Is there a Rishon who addresses it directly, or is the resolution "malachim aren't גבי חיוב

Q6. The pattern across this series is "davening structure accommodates the weak/late/unlearned." Is that a formal halachic principle you can name, or is it more of a meta-observation about the מסדרי הסידור

6. Bottom Line

This is the second installment of the Shabbos Shacharis arc, and it delivers exactly what the series has been promising — the human/historical texture behind the words we say every week. The Toledo/Ibn Shushan piece is the best thing in the shiur and the kind of set-piece that will stick with talmidim for years; the Adam HaRishon sunrise for הארת is close behind. The Rav's characteristic strengths are on display: warmth, willingness to admit he's still researching, integration of Jewish history with liturgical detail, sensitivity to the mispallel who doesn't know why he's saying what he's saying. The weaker moments — Nishmas cut short, הארת underdeveloped, sourcing sometimes loose — are all time-management issues rather than substantive gaps. With the next three weeks pivoting to Rosh Hashanah machzor and the Shabbos Shacharis arc resuming after Yom Tov, this shiur functions well as a "pause point" — it closes the added-kapitlach chapter cleanly and opens the Shemoneh Esrei / Nishmas material as a cliffhanger to be picked up post-chagim.

Produced by a content-based review pass — the reviewer was given the full transcript, summary, and the finished write-up, and asked to react to the shiur itself (not the write-up). Complement to the Independent Editorial Review.